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Waqar H. Zaidi

'Aviation Will Either Destroy or Save Our Civilization': Proposals for the International Control of Aviation, 1920–45

Abstract

Proposals for the internationalization of civil aviation and the formation of an international air force blossomed in Britain, France and the United States between 1920 and 1945. The proposals were promoted by liberal internationalist constituencies in these three countries and reveal an enthusiasm for technocracy and technology within liberal internationalism. Aviation, internationalists argued, was too dangerous and held too much potential to be left in the hands of warring nations. It should instead be controlled by an international organization for the benefit of international peace and prosperity. Proposals were linked to the League of Nations in the interwar period and to the proposed United Nations Organization during the second world war. They were discussed at the 1932 League of Nations Geneva disarmament conference, and in 1944, at the Dumbarton Oaks Conference and the Chicago conference on international civil aviation.

Keywords: aviation, collective security, disarmament, international air force, League of Nations, liberal internationalism

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The following abbreviations are used in this paper: Cecil Papers (Cecil of Chelwood Papers, British Library Manuscripts Collection, British Library); Chat Papers (Records of the Royal Institute of International Affairs, Chatham House, London); CFR Papers (Records of the Council on Foreign Relations, 1921–51, British Library of Political and Economic Science); Davies Papers (David Davies of Llandinam Papers, National Library of Wales); HC Deb (House of Commons Debates, Hansard); HL Deb (House of Lords Debates, Hansard); LNU Papers (Papers of the League of Nations Union, British Library of Political and Economic Science); Murray Papers (Gilbert Murray Papers, Modern Western Manuscripts, Bodleian Library, Oxford University); NARA (National Archives and Records Administration, Maryland, United States); PNB Papers (Noel Baker Papers, Churchill Archives Centre, Cambridge University); PRO (The National Archives, UK); WCA Papers (World Citizen Association Papers, Special Collections Research Center, University of Chicago Library); Woolf Papers (Leonard Woolf Papers, Special Collections, University of Sussex Library); Wright Papers (Quincy Wright Papers, Special Collections Research Center, University of Chicago Library).

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On 25 August 1944, the British delegation at the Dumbarton Oaks Conference on postwar international organization cabled London to seek guidance from Winston Churchill on a Soviet suggestion that the proposed United Nations Organization be armed with a permanent International Air Force. Churchill ordered the delegation not to reject the proposal, and went on:

> The matter raises very large questions of principle and cannot be decided on purely military grounds. I am quite sure the Russian proposal will gain very great acceptance in Great Britain and it certainly seems by weaving the forces of different countries together to give assurances of permanent peace. My views on this subject were expressed after the last war and may be read in the opening chapters of the 'Aftermath.' . . . The introduction of an international air force is an event of the utmost importance and cannot possibly be settled on departmental consideration.[1]

Churchill had indeed made reference to the formation of such a force in the *Aftermath* volume of his history of the Great War, *The World Crisis*, published in 1929. In it, he had explained his vision of how lasting international peace and security could have been achieved. He suggested that Wilson, Clemenceau and Lloyd George could have cast aside their national interests and recognized instead that the latest scientific weapon, the 'power of the air', was too dangerous to be left in the hands of fickle nations. It could instead be internationally controlled, 'reserved to the League of Nations for the purpose of maintaining world peace against aggression'. National aviation was to be abolished, ushering in a new era of international relations: 'the whole emphasis of the policy of the Great Powers would be laid upon building up the International Air Force'. Churchill's enthusiasm for internationalized aviation was to survive the second world war and was clearly expressed in what one historian has described as the 'most important, and the most influential, of all Churchill's post-war addresses' – his 1946 Fulton Missouri speech on postwar international relations. Remembered today for its references to the 'iron curtain' and the 'special relationship', historians have forgotten that it was also a call to arm the UN with a powerful international air force. Unless this was done, he warned, 'the Stone Age may return on the gleaming wings of science, and what might now shower immeasurable material blessings upon mankind, may even bring about its total destruction.'[2]

This article charts the rise and fall of proposals such as Churchill's and shows that they were commonplace in Britain, France and the United States between 1920 and 1945. In these years, liberal internationalists came to believe that aviation held the key to not only collective security but the future of international relations itself. Their proposals for the international control of aviation called for the removal of military and civil aviation from the control

1 Telegram, J.S.R., Washington to A.M.S.S.O., London (25 August 1944), CAB 120/837, PRO. Prime Minister's Personal Minute, Foreign Secretary General Ismay for C.O.S. Committee (29 August 1944), CAB 120/837, PRO.

2 Winston S. Churchill, *The World Crisis: The Aftermath* (London 1929), 27; Winston Churchill, 'The Soviet Danger: The Iron Curtain', in David Cannadine (ed.), *The Speeches of Winston Churchill* (London 1989), 295–308.

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of the nation-state, and its relinquishment instead to some international authority. Typically, international civil aviation was to be controlled, either through outright ownership or strongly regulated licensing, by an international authority such as the League. National military forces were to be drastically curtailed (and often eventually abolished), with an international air force, controlled by international authority, remaining as the most potent military force. This force was to both police aviation and keep peace and order throughout the territories of the signatory nations. Although not universal, either in terms of the countries participating, the territory covered, or the types of aviation included, and often gradualist in nature, these proposals were nevertheless strikingly internationalist. Although they did not materialize, they are nevertheless worthy of study because of what they tell us about the nature of liberal internationalist thinking on aviation and international relations.[3]

Historians of disarmament have seen these proposals as attempts, sincere or insincere, to achieve disarmament or collective security. They have not, however, explained why these attempts focused on aviation and took the form of international control, and nor have they analysed the rationales presented for such proposals.[4] Calls for the formation of an international air police have, for the British case, received significant attention, but have been explained as a manifestation of British fear of the bomber.[5] Enthusiasm for aviation and a broader urge to reconstruct international relations is missing from these

3 The term 'liberal internationalist' is already widely used by historians of interwar Britain to refer to those interested in ensuring international peace through international law, international trade and co-operation, and limits on the sovereignty of nation-states. For one definition see: Paul Rich, 'Reinventing Peace: David Davies, Alfred Zimmern and Liberal Internationalism in Interwar Britain', *International Relations* 16(1) (2002), 117–33. For a study of some influential British liberal internationalists, see David Long and Peter Wilson (eds), *Thinkers of the Twenty Years Crisis: Inter-war Idealism Reassessed* (Oxford 1995). I extend this usage to the United States (where the term 'Wilsonian internationalist' has typically been preferred) and France (where I use it to refer to those internationalists and supporters of the League on the Centre and Centre Left of the political spectrum). In the latter case I build on a recent reinterpretation of France's interwar search for security through the League as being liberal internationalist in nature: Peter Jackson, 'France and the Problems of Security and International Disarmament after the First World War', *The Journal of Strategic Studies* 29(2) (April 2006), 247–80.

4 Carolyn Kitching, *Britain and the Geneva Disarmament Conference: A Study in International History* (Basingstoke 2003), 55–73; Maurice Vaïsse, *Sécurité D'abord: la Politique Française en Matière de Désarmement, 9 Décembre 1930–17 Avril 1934* (Paris 1981), 193–209.

5 Gwyn Jenkins, 'Lord Davies, Howard Hughes and "The Quinine Proposition": The Plan to Set up an International Air Force to Defend Chinese Cities from Japanese Air Raids, 1938', *The National Library of Wales Journal* 21(4) (Winter 1980), 414–22; Richard S. Grayson, *The Liberals, International Relations and Appeasement: The Liberal Party 1919–1939* (London 2001), 154; Martin Ceadel, *Semi-detached Idealists: The British Peace Movement and International Relations, 1854–1945* (Oxford 2000), 283–5; Roger Beaumont, *Right Backed by Might: The International Air Force Concept* (Westport, CT, 2001); Michael Pugh, 'Policing the World: Lord Davies and the Quest for Order in the 1930s', *International Relations* 16(1) (2002), 97–115. Recent work has applied this explanation more broadly to international control: Brett Holman, 'The Next War in the Air: Civilian Fears of Strategic Bombardment in Britain, 1908–1941', unpublished PhD dissertation, University of Melbourne, 2009. For the argument that the British national reaction to aviation was most significantly one of fear of the bomber, see Uri Bialer,

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explanations. Instead, these histories fall within a broader approach to the relations of aviation and culture which has portrayed enthusiasm for aviation, particularly military aviation, as a nationalist disorder associated with fascism or totalitarianism, and not pacifism, liberalism, or internationalism.[6] This article, by contrast, builds on the idea that much of liberal Britain embraced aviation and bombing in particular; and that a broader liberal internationalism played a crucial role in thinking about the aviation in Britain from the interwar period onwards.[7] I show that in Britain, France and the USA liberal internationalists were the central proponents of international control, which was articulated on the basis of particular assumptions about the nature of, not only aviation and the state of international relations, but also militarism, the role of experts, and the effects of modern science and technology on war and international relations. Although support for proposals for international control was closely tied to the vicissitudes of the concept of League collective security, to reduce the former to the latter would be to miss crucial aspects of international control – such as the drive to rationalize international transport and communications, to transform international relations more generally, and its connections to aerial policing in Empire.

Although proposals for the formation of some form of supranational peacekeeping police force have been traced back to as early as the nineteenth century by its proponents and detractors, this concept only really began to gain credence in Europe in the few years prior to the first world war. By 1915, proposals for international peace through collective security in the form of an international police force became widespread in Britain and Continental Europe. Prominent liberal thinkers on international relations, such as Norman Angell and J.A. Hobson, called for such a force in Britain. On the mainland the Dutch legal scholar Cornelis van Vollenhoven became a prominent proponent. Proposals ranged from a force formed when required from national contingents (and disbanded afterwards) to a permanent independently and internationally administered standing force with no national allegiance. Once the League of Nations was formed, internationalists agitated for it to be armed with a powerful international force. There were publications,

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The Shadow of the Bomber: The Fear of Air Attack and British Politics 1932–1939 (London 1980); and Malcolm Smith, *British Air Strategy Between the Wars* (Oxford 1984).

6 Peter Fritzsche, *A Nation of Fliers: German Aviation and the Popular Imagination* (Cambridge, MA, 1992); Sean Kennedy, 'The Croix de Feu, the Parti Social Français, and the Politics of Aviation, 1931–1939', *French Historical Studies* 23(2) (Spring 2000), 373–99. Guillaume De Syon, *Zeppelin! Germany and the Airship, 1900–1939* (Baltimore 2002); Robert Wohl, *The Spectacle of Flight: Aviation and the Western Imagination, 1920–1950* (New Haven, CT, 2005); Bernhard Rieger, *Technology and the Culture of Modernity in Britain and Germany, 1890–1945* (Cambridge 2005), 116–57; Scott W. Palmer, *Dictatorship of the Air: Aviation Culture and the Fate of Modern Russia* (New York 2006).

7 David Edgerton, *England and the Aeroplane: An Essay on a Militant and Technological Nation* (Basingstoke 1991); David Edgerton, *Warfare State: Britain, 1920–1970* (Cambridge 2006), 52–8, 313–18.

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discussions within internationalist organizations, letters to the national press, petitions to Government and proposals put before the League Assembly.[8]

The belief in the desirability and viability of some form of international force continued to strengthen in the 1920s, and as it did so calls for a purely or predominantly aerial force came to the fore and became increasingly popular amongst liberal internationalists. A League air force was suggested in the House of Commons in 1920 as an alternative to continued funding of British military aviation, and at the 1922 League Assembly Robert Cecil (a leading supporter of the League in Britain, and then chairman of the Executive Committee of the League of Nations Union), although against a strongly armed League on the basis that it would further deter American participation, nevertheless suggested that making air forces the League's 'special weapon' would facilitate disarmament. Industrialist and Liberal MP David Davies emerged as the leading proponent of an international air police in Britain in the 1920s, and put it at the centre of his calls for a reconstructed international relations, as in, for example, his 1930 magnum opus *Problem of the Twentieth Century*. He had since the war focused on the destructiveness and effectiveness of what he understood to be new scientific weapons (a 1920 letter to *The Times* complained: 'Throughout the world scientists are pointing a pistol at the heart of humanity, and humanity not only gratefully pays for the pistol, but begs the scientist to find a more deadly one'). He consequently suggested that the latest scientific weapons be banned from national armies, and instead reserved for an international police force consisting of a permanent air, sea and land arm. The international force's monopoly of the most scientific, and so the most effective, weapons would ensure its cost-effectiveness. It would prevail over national armed forces, which would have recourse only to the inferior less-scientific weapons developed before the first world war. The aeroplane, being the most powerful of these new weapons, was to play the most important part in his force – the air element was to be its vanguard. National air forces were to be gradually disbanded, and commercial aeroplanes capable of bombing were to be given up to the international police force as well. National commercial aviation would be allowed to continue its development, though now unhindered by military demands. The international bombers would be used to bomb nations in breach of international law, as judged by an 'Equity Tribunal', and

8 For pre-first world war histories, see David Davies, *The Problem of the Twentieth Century: A Study of International Relationships* (London 1930), 110–15; J.M. Spaight, *An International Air Police* (London 1932), 29–45; and Hans Wehberg, 'La Police Internationale', *Recueil des Cours* 48 (1934 part II), 1–132; J.A. Hobson, *Towards International Government* (London 1915), 72–89; Norman Angell, 'Introduction', in Edward Krehbiel, *Nationalism, War and Society* (New York 1916), xiii–xxxv; Cornelis van Vollenhoven et al., *War Obviated by an International Police: A Series of Essays, Written in Various Countries* (The Hague 1915). David Davies, 'Disarmament', *Transactions of the Grotius Society* 5 (1919), 109–18; David Davies, Letter to the Editor, 'More Armaments: A Menace to Future Peace, An International Police', *The Times*, 1 April 1920; 'International Police: Deputation to the Prime Minister', *The Times*, 17 June 1920; 'Arbitration, Security and Reduction of Armaments: Extracts from Debates of the Fifth Assembly', League of Nations C. 708 1924 IX (CCOI) (Geneva 1924), 155, 271–4.

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so to act as a deterrent to international aggression. Aviation factories and development facilities were to be placed under the direct control of an international authority, further ensuring that advances in 'aeronautical science' would occur quickly (less wasteful competition) and accrue only to the international air force.[9]

This turn to aviation was a product of a growing society-wide fascination with aviation, a mounting belief in its transformative powers and continuing discussions within the League on aerial disarmament. It was widely assumed that aviation would be the pre-eminent weapon in any future war, enabling the aggressor to achieve a 'knock-out blow' against which there was no defence. Aviation appeared to allow for the control of vast territories spread across the globe, and promised to transform international relations through its ability to transcend national boundaries, its speed, its reach, and the technical and apolitical nature of aviators. Collective security, previously prey to objections about the expense and sluggishness of the required armies and navies, could now be efficiently and effectively instituted.[10]

The 1932 Geneva Conference on disarmament proved a crucial spur to proposals for the international control of aviation in Britain and France. In February 1932 André Tardieu, French Minister of War, laid before the Conference for the Reduction and Limitation of Armaments a proposal that brushed aside the prior work of the League of Nations Preparatory Commission and instead focused on international control of aviation as the key to European security. The Plan called for all heavy military aircraft to be transferred to an International Air Force under the control of the League of Nations. The construction and development of national military aircraft, save the very lightest ones, was to be forbidden. Individual nations were to be prohibited from developing heavy civilian aircraft – all such existing aircraft were to be transferred to an international civil transport service under the League, which would then have a monopoly on establishing and operating all international airlines, including transport between nations and their colonies. In order to deter aggression, police the colonies and oversee the development of aviation amongst the member nations, Tardieu proposed the creation of an International Police Force, consisting of national contingents but under the command of the League of Nations. Other advanced weapons, such as

9 Liberal Joseph Montague Kenworthy in the Commons: HC Deb, 11 March 1920, vol. 126, cols 1639–40. On Cecil, see Spaight, *An International Air Police*, op. cit., 31; and Letter, Robert Cecil to J.C. Smuts (6 October 1922), 51076/112–114, Cecil Papers. David Davies, Letter to the Editor, 'More Armaments: A Menace to Future Peace, An International Police', *The Times*, 1 April 1920. Davies, *The Problem of the Twentieth Century*, op. cit., 297–339, 360–82, 475. For more on Davies's activities, see Neil D. Bauernfeind, 'Lord Davies and the New Commonwealth Society 1932–1944', unpublished MPhil Dissertation, University of Wales at Aberystwyth, 1990.

10 On League discussions, see Kenneth W. Colegrove, *International Control of Aviation* (Boston, MA, 1930), 127–9, 131–42; Bialer, *The Shadow of the Bomber*, op. cit.; Wohl, *The Spectacle of Flight*, op. cit.; David E. Omissi, *Air Power and Colonial Control: The Royal Air Force 1919–1939* (Manchester 1990).

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long-range artillery, heavy capital ships and submarines, were also to be placed under the control of the League.[11]

The proposals came as a surprise not only to the conference delegates but to French political commentators too. Press reaction followed ideological fault-lines: papers of the Centre, such as *Coly*, *l'Orde* and *L'Echo de Paris* took a sceptical stance; Republican papers, such as *La Votonie* and *L'œuvre*, supported the Tardieu Plan; and the socialist and communist papers, *La Populaire* and *le Soir*, were against it. *Le Figaro* explained the proposals as a tactical manoeuvre designed to expose German hypocrisy over disarmament. Leon Blum, the leader of the Socialist Party, spoke out strongly against the Plan. Pacifist *La Paix* denounced the Tardieu Plan because it sprung from a 'pacifistes militarisant' tendency. There was no single solution to war, it argued. The conservatively inclined Geneva-based law journal *Revue de Droit International* described the Tardieu Plan as an outcome of careful technical military planning, and condemned the disarmament proposals of 'des socialistes et pacifistes' as a sham: 'Pour des raisons électorales, pour des raisons encore pires, des illuminés ou des agents de l'internationalisme ont lancé l'idée du désarmement'.[12]

Internationalists and the Radical Party supported the scheme, through expressed indignation at the fact that a ministry of the Centre-Right had adopted proposals they had been espousing for years. Of the leading European-integrationist journals, *L'Ère Nouvelle* supported the proposals wholeheartedly, whereas *Notre Temps* gave its approval more grudgingly.[13] *L'Europe Nouvelle*'s editor and co-founder Louise Weiss pointed out that the proposals adopted by Tardieu had just been made at a major internationalist conference on disarmament held only a few months earlier at the Trocadéro in Paris.[14] As well as Weiss, those attending included leading French Radical politicians, and British and French internationalists such as Robert Cecil, Philip Noel-Baker, Edouard Herriot, Henry de Jouvenel, Salvador de Madariaga, Pierre Cot and Paul Painlevé.[15]A resolution calling for the international control of aviation had been agreed at a preparatory meeting in July 1931 and was duly passed by the conference.[16] Radical Party members also

11 'Proposals of the French Delegation, Conf. D.56, Geneva, 5 February 1932', in *Conference for the Reduction and Limitation of Armaments. Conference Documents* vol. 1, League Publication IX. Disarmament 1932.IX.63 (Geneva December 1932), 113–16.

12 See the press review in 'Revue de la Presse', *La République* 973 (8 February 1932); also 'La contre-offensive Française a Genève', *Le Figaro* (7 February 1932). R. Froger-Doudement, 'D'une Force de Police Internationale', *La Paix* VII (July, August 1932), 182–8. 'Conférence Du Désarmement, II – Premier Acte', *Revue de Droit International* 16 (1932), 393–484.

13 'Editorial', *L'Ere Nouvelle* 5166 (8 February 1932); Jean Luchaire, 'Vers la S.D.N. super-Ètat?', *Notre Temps* 13(129) (14 February 1932), 105–11.

14 Louise Weiss, 'Bataille de discours et de propositions', *L'Europe Nouvelle* 731 (13 February 1932), 193–7.

15 For more on La Conférence d'Etudes pour le Désarmement, see *L'Europe Nouvelle* 721 (5 December 1931).

16 'New Campaign for Disarmament', *Manchester Guardian* (27 July 1931).

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claimed this idea as their own. The party's newspaper, *La République*, reprinted resolutions calling for the international control of aviation from the November 1931 annual Radical Party conference at Wagram, and Radicals such as Pierre Cot announced that the originator of such proposals was the diplomat and Radical Party politician Henry de Jouvenel.[17] Jouvenel had indeed been a leading proponent of international control since the late 1920s, and the author, alongside other internationalists, of detailed proposals for a 'Union Aérienne Internationale' in 1931.[18] The announcement of the Tardieu Plan led to a deluge of calls for international control from these constituencies. Louise Weiss's *L'Europe Nouvelle* reiterated its existing proposals, and a major peace conference held in Vienna in September 1932 also called for international control.[19]

The French proposal at Geneva surprised all in Britain too. It was greeted positively by liberal internationalists and negatively by the Left, the Conservative-led government, the Air Ministry and aviation communities. *Flight*, a leading British aviation magazine, dismissed the French proposal as an 'electioneering move' and Charles G. Grey, the influential editor of *Aeroplane* magazine, described it as a 'ridiculous and grotesque' attempt by the French to grab the limelight and to appear internationally minded. He held that, as Britain had a stronger air force than either the French or the Americans, the French proposals would simply allow France to control British men and materials. *The Times* expressed scepticism not only about the French plan but about the League of Nations itself, and offered the Commonwealth as an alternative model for world order. The French, *The Times* argued, were afraid of an aerial attack and were only willing to reduce armaments that they themselves did not possess. The *Daily Express* ran the headline: 'France Staggers Geneva. Plan to Make the League Over-Lord of the World'.[20] The government's

17 Gabriel Cudenet, 'Un plan… ou un jeu?', *La République* 972 (7 February 1932); 'Vingt-sixième Congres Radical: Ordre du jour sur la Conférence du désarmement', *La République* 972 (7 February 1932); Pierre Cot, 'M. Tardieu défendra-t-il a Genève tout le programme radical?', *La République* 975 (10 February 1932).

18 Henry de Jouvenel, 'Internationalisez l'aviation', *La Revue des Vivants* 2 (October 1928), 725–33; Pierre Brossolette, 'Sur un projet de réduction des armements aériens', *Notre Temps* 118 (29 November 1931), 513–18.

19 'L'aviation, Problème-Clef du Désarmement', *L'Europe Nouvelle* 763 (24 September 1932), 1123–5; Laurent Eynac, 'L'internationalisation des transports aériens', *L'Europe Nouvelle* 763 (24 September 1932), 1125–7. Lucien le Foyer, 'La Question du désarmement', *La Paix* VII (July, August 1932), 150–65. Other proposals for internationalization published in early 1932 include: André Daniel Tolédano, *Ce qu'il faut savoir sur le désarmement (avec en annexe le projet de convention du désarmement)* (Paris 1932); and Louis Perillier, *De La Limitation des Armements par la méthode budgétaire et du contrôle de cette limitation* (Paris 1932).

20 'Editorial Comment', *Flight* XXIV (12 February 1932), 125–6; C.G. Grey, 'On Disarmament', *The Aeroplane* XLII (10 February 1932), 217–26; 'A Discouraging Reception', *The Times*, 8 February 1932; 'Initiative Seized by France: Comment in Paris', *The Times*, 8 February 1932. The *Spectator* agreed with *The Times*: 'Disarmament', *The Spectator*, 13 February 1932; 'France Staggers Geneva: Plan to Make the League Over-Lord of the World', *Daily Express*, 6 February 1932.

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response was negative and was typified by Robert Vansittart, the Permanent Under-Secretary at the Foreign Office:

> the proposals now made under this head are either a device for ensuring the military superiority of France in the immediate future, or that they are deliberately inserted with the idea that they will be rejected by others, upon whom the blame for failure can be thrown.[21]

The Air Ministry believed that although the French proposal was formulated with Germany in mind, it was nevertheless a threat to British aviation; and lobbied hard to convince government that it was not feasible and not in the British national interest. League control of civil aviation not only 'constituted an intolerable interference with purely commercial enterprise and conferred on the League the right to interfere with a normal method of civil transport', but would anyway be unable to prevent the conversion of commercial aircraft into military aircraft in time of war, which could be carried out quickly and secretly. The French plan appeared so unfeasible, the Air Staff reasoned, that it had to be in reality nothing more than a 'political gesture'.[22] A final Air Ministry charge was one of hypocrisy:

> the advocacy by the French at Geneva of extreme measures of internationalisation for civil aviation in relation, no doubt, to the fear of German re-armament through civil aviation, is in very marked contrast to the policy of intense nationalism which, in practice, informs their attitude to the operations over French territory of any non-French civil aviation enterprises.[23]

The Air Ministry sanctioned a direct and public rebuttal, in the form of the lawyer and air-power advocate James M. Spaight's 1932 book *An International Air Police*, which insisted instead that a strong national air force consisting of heavy bombers would best ensure peace through deterrence.[24]

Much of this criticism was not far off the mark, of course: Tardieu did not expect these proposals to be accepted. He did not consider the Conference to be the appropriate venue for the serious discussion of disarmament – the proposals were tactical manoeuvres within the larger context of French foreign policy. In Tardieu's own words: 'La réalité de la conférence, à ses débuts au

21 Letter, Robert Vansittart to the Foreign Secretary, 'The French Proposals' (24 November 1932), AIR 8/146, PRO. For more on the British response to the French proposals, see Kitching, *Britain and the Geneva Disarmament Conference*, op. cit., 55; and Carolyn J. Kitching, *Britain and the Problem of International Disarmament 1919–34* (London 1999), 140–73.

22 Memo by the Air Staff, 'Note by the Air Staff on the French Proposals Contained in Document Conf.D.56 dated 5.2.32' (c. February 1932), AIR 8/132, PRO. For lobbying, see Letter, J.M. Salmond to A. Eden (10 March 1933), AIR 2/664, PRO; Telegram, J.M. Salmond to Air Marshall John Steel, R.A.F. Simla (26 July 1932), AIR 8/145, PRO; and the file 'India and the Proposal to Abolish Bombing' (9 May 1932–4 November 1933), AIR 8/145, PRO.

23 Letter, J.S. Ross (Air Ministry) to the Under Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs (29 August 1934), AIR 2/665, PRO.

24 Spaight, *An International Air Police*, op. cit.

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moins, ne sera pas la réalité de tous les jours. Ce sera une réalité démagogique et théâtrale.'[25]

The Left, viewing the League as a conduit for Anglo-French imperialist policies, was naturally opposed to the Tardieu proposals, and indeed any other proposals for League collective security. For the Communist Party ideologue R. Palme Dutt, the League had no authority or identity independent of the Great Powers: a League police would be a Great Power police. The journalist and author H.N. Brailsford warned that 'A League army to-day would be the picked police force of allied capitalism'. The left wing of the Labour Party, set against League collective security, voiced its opposition to Labourite proposals for international control through the New Fabian Research Bureau and the Socialist League.[26]

British liberal internationalists had already begun to graduate from calling solely for an international air police or the international control of military aviation to calling for the complete internationalization of both military and civil aviation by the late twenties.[27] This trend was exacerbated by their exposure to French proposals between 1930 and 1932, the culmination of which was the Tardieu Plan itself. The Plan provided a massive boost to British liberal internationalists' activity and credibility to their proposals, and allowed them more fully to incorporate the internationalization of civil aviation into their programmes for international relations. David Davies was quick to capitalize on the Tardieu Plan and press speculation linking it to his pre-existing proposals.[28] He republished and produced an abridged version of his *The Problem of the Twentieth Century*, and (in October 1932) founded the New Commonwealth Society to agitate for his proposals, as well as a New Commonwealth Institute which published more broadly on international relations.[29] The Institute and the Society would go on to push for international control through conferences, at the

25 Vaïsse, *Sécurité D'abord*, op. cit., 198.

26 R.P. Dutt, *World Politics 1918–1936* (London 1936), 131; H.N. Brailsford, 'A Socialist Foreign Policy', in C. Addison et. al., *Problems of a Socialist Government* (London 1933), 252–86; Report, John Parker, New Fabian Research Bureau, 'Conference on Foreign Affairs' (October 1934), 2/12, PNB PAPERS; Paul Corthorn, 'The Labour Party and the League of Nations: The Socialist League's Role in the Sanctions Crisis of 1935', *Twentieth Century British History* 13(1) (2002), 62–85.

27 A prominent example being a Labour parliamentary motion: HC Deb, 12 March 1928, vol. 214, cols 1609–18. One supporter was the Labour MP Rennie Smith, who also called for it in Rennie Smith, *General Disarmament or War?* (London 1927). Much earlier were Kipling's stories of an 'Aerial Board of Control': Rudyard Kipling, 'With the Night Mail: A Story of 2000 AD', in idem., *Actions and Reactions* (London 1909); Rudyard Kipling, *As Easy as A.B.C.* (London 1912); and the musings of motoring enthusiast Lord Montague of Beaulieu at the Aeronautical Society of Great Britain: 'Pathways in the Air: Lord Montague on the Future of Flight, Duties of Aerial Police', *The Times*, 22 June 1917.

28 Raymond Poincaré, 'La Paix Dans La Sécurité', *Excelsior*, 8 February 1932; '40,000 Women Plead for World Peace. Clash of Plans at Geneva: How Nations Received the French Proposals', *Reynolds News*, 7 February 1932.

29 David Davies, *The Problem of the Twentieth Century: A Study of International Relationships* (London 1934).

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League of Nations Union and other internationalist organizations, and through publications throughout the thirties.[30] Prominently, the New Commonwealth Institute organized lectures on an international air force and the internationalization of civil aviation for the eighth International Studies Conference of the Institute of Intellectual Cooperation held in London in June 1935.[31] The Society supported the Tardieu Plan, embracing in particular internationalization of civil aviation, which had been missing from Davies's earlier proposals in the twenties.[32]

Internationalists who had held ambiguous positions on international control turned for it after 1932. Diplomat and political scientist Philip Noel-Baker's 1926 *Disarmament* had recognized the threat from the bomber but had not called for international control, yet by 1934 he was calling for it along with the complete abolition of bombers. The Executive of the League of Nations Union, including its President Robert Cecil, had, in order to appease its Conservative constituency, for years resisted grass-roots and New Commonwealth pressure to back an international police force. It gradually succumbed from 1934 onwards – finally committing itself to complete international control in 1935, and holding a prominent conference on 'Aviation as an International Problem' the same year. The League even added a question on the abolition of military aviation to its 1934–5 Peace Ballot. The half a million volunteers who conducted the Poll were advised to mention an international police force if questioned on collective security during polling. Of those polled, 82.5 per cent voted for the abolition of national military aircraft; and afterwards the National Declaration Committee regretted not incorporating the internationalization of civil aviation, which it believed would have elicited an even higher positive response.[33] Other prominent liberal internationalists to call for

30 For example, at a pacifist conference in Brussels in February 1934: *An International Air Force: its Functions and Organisation / being a Memorandum submitted by the Executive Committee of the New Commonwealth to the International Congress in Defence of Peace, Brussels, February, 1934* (London 1934).

31 These were subsequently published, and included: Rear Admiral Robert Neale Lawson, *A Plan for the Organisation of a European Air Service* (London 1935); H.R.G. Greaves, *An International Police Board* (London 1935); and Pierre Cot, *Military Force or Air Police* (London 1935).

32 As well as the works already noted, Davies also published: David Davies, *An International Air Force: Its Functions and Organisation* (London 1934); and David Davies, *Force and the Future* (London 1934). As well as its own proposals, the Society published writings by others, prominently Edmund Allenby's Rectorial Address delivered to Edinburgh University in 1936: Edmund Allenby, *Allenby's Last Message: World Police for World Peace* (London 1936); and Henry de Jouvenel's *Aviation for World Service* (London 1933).

33 Philip Noel-Baker, *Disarmament* (London 1926), 40, 41, 213–44; P.J. Noel-Baker, 'Disarmament', *International Affairs* 13(1) (January–February 1934), 3–25; Philip Noel-Baker, 'The International Air Police Force', in idem. et al., *Challenge to Death* (London 1934), 206–39. League of Nations Union, *The Problem of the Air* (London 1935). For notes and guides to the ballot, see *Worker's Guide* (July 1934), 2/22, PNB Papers; and National Declaration Committee, *Peace or War? A National Declaration on the League of Nations and Armaments: Notes on the Five Questions in the Ballot Paper* (London 1934). On Conservative objections, see Martin Ceadel, 'The First British Referendum: The Peace Ballot, 1934–5', *The English Historical Review* 95 (377) (October 1980), 810–39; J.A. Thompson, 'The "Peace Ballot" and the "Rainbow" Controversy', *The Journal of British Studies* 20(2) (Spring 1981), 150–70.

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international control included J.A. Hobson and the General Secretary of the League of Nations Union, Maxwell Garnett. Even the military thinker and historian B.H. Liddell Hart came to support an international force armed with modern 'mechanical' weapons.[34]

This upswell of interest was underpinned by support from within the Liberal and Labour Parties. The Liberal MP Geoffrey Mander championed international control at the Liberal Summer Schools and in the House of Commons. With his backing international control remained on the agenda of the National Liberal Federation conferences between 1932 and 1935, when several resolutions were passed in its support. A group of Liberals, seeking radical policies for their party, issued a manifesto in 1932 which included support for Davies's international air police. With Arthur Henderson's support, the Labour Party Annual Conference passed its first resolution calling for an international police force in 1933. At the October 1934 Annual Conference in Southport international control of aviation was adopted as policy by the Labour Executive. Attlee went on to publish his views on the need for international control in a New Commonwealth Society pamphlet; and the Labour Party presented international control as a central foreign policy proposal in its 1935 General Election Manifesto, and reaffirmed its commitment in 1936.[35]

The liberal press welcomed the proposals too, and took up the cause of international control to varying extents. For the *News Chronicle* the French proposals were 'revolutionary' and 'more ambitious and far-reaching than any the League of Nations has ever conceived of'. After initially greeting the Tardieu Plan as 'propagandist', the *Manchester Guardian* became a strong supporter of international control of aviation. *The Economist*, already a supporter of the League of Nations, free trade and disarmament, on the basis that nations were increasingly economically and politically interdependent, admitted that the French had the most to benefit from the formation of a League air force, but nevertheless welcomed aerial disarmament and declared that the case for internationalization of civil aviation was 'overwhelming' on the basis that

34 J.A. Hobson, 'Force Necessary to Government', *Hibbert Journal* 33(3) (April 1935), 331–42; and Maxwell Garnett, Letter to the Editor, 'Collective Defence. The Use of an International Air Force', *Manchester Guardian*, 11 June 1934; Liddell Hart, 'An International Force', *Royal Institute of International Affairs 1931–1939* 12(2) (March 1932), 205–23.

35 HC Deb, 13 December 1933, vol. 284, cols 445–502; Geoffrey Le Mesurier Mander, 'Military Disarmament', *Forward View* 3(32) (September 1929), 124; Grayson, *The Liberals, International Relations and Appeasement*, op. cit., 164–77; also, 'Resolution on Peace and Security', *Liberal Magazine* XLIII (June 1935), 56–60. Hubert Phillips et al., *Whither Britain? A Radical Answer* (London 1932); the Labour Party, *Labour Party Annual Conference Report* (London 1933), 192; Henry Ralph Winkler, *British Labour seeks a Foreign Policy, 1900–1940* (New Brunswick, NJ, 2005), 104; Clement R. Attlee, *An International Police Force* (London 1934); F.W.S. Craig, *British General Election Manifestos 1918–1966* (Chichester 1970), 81–83; National Executive Committee, *Labour's Immediate Programme* (London 1937).

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'Flying is supra-national in its very nature' and 'a safeguard against being bombed wholesale'.[36]

The most radical and complete schemes for internationalization came from the radical liberal 'Next Five Years Group', whose founder, Clifford Allen, was a vocal proponent. Convinced that 'Aviation will either destroy or save our civilization', he ensured that the Group made international control central to its foreign policy demands.[37] He was most publicly supported by fellow Group member Jonathan Griffin, editor of the weekly news digest *Essential News*.[38] Both Allen and Griffin took particularly uncompromising positions. Clifford Allen refused to sign a letter to *The Times* because it proposed an interim European international air force before the formation of a permanent one and because national air forces were not to be immediately abolished, only withered down over time. He wanted instead complete and immediate international control. Griffin went further than most proponents by also explicitly calling for the complete abolition of private aviation, which was, he maintained, nothing more than a form of national military armament.[39]

Not all liberal opinion was favourably disposed towards international control. Many in the peace movement in the 1930s continued to argue that force could never be a solution in international affairs, leading to a widening of the already present split in the pacifist movements between those advocating collective security and those eschewing force altogether. The pacifist Helena Swanwick and the National Peace Council both supported the abolition of national air forces and the internationalization of civil aviation, and yet also opposed the use of force and so opposed an international air force. A group of

36 'Great Disarmament Sensation. France's Sweeping Proposals – League to Control War Forces', *News Chronicle*, 6 February 1932; 'Reasons for the French Move', *Manchester Guardian*, 6 February 1932; 'Civil Aviation and Air Warfare. Internationalisation', *Manchester Guardian*, 10 September 1932; 'Civil Aviation and Air Warfare. Internationalisation II', *Manchester Guardian*, 13 September 1932; 'Plan for the Air', *Manchester Guardian*, 21 May 1935; Editorial, 'The Disarmament Conference', *The Economist* 114 (13 February 1932), 340–1; 'French Plan', *The Economist* 115 (19 November 1932), 916–17; 'Disarmament in the Air', *The Economist* 116 (5 February 1933), 399. The *Daily Herald*, to the left of these publications, greeted the Tardieu Plan by questioning French sincerity. 'Is France Sincere?', *Daily Herald*, 6 February 1932.

37 Quote from: Clifford Allen, Letter to the Editor, *The Times*, 14 December 1933. See also Clifford Allen et al., Letter to the Editor, 'A Disarmament Programme', *Manchester Guardian*, 22 December 1933; and Clifford Allen et al., Letter to the Editor, 'Disarm or Rearm?', *Manchester Guardian*, 17 February 1934; Martin Gilbert, *Plough My Own Furrow: The Story of Lord Allen of Hurtwood as Told Through his Writings and Correspondence* (London 1965), 291–309, 331–49; Clifford Allen, 'Public Opinion and the Idea of International Government', *International Affairs* 13(2) (March–April 1934), 186–207; Clifford Allen, *Britain's Political Future: A Plea For Liberty and Leadership* (London 1934), 116–17.

38 Jonathan Griffin, *World Airways – Why Not? A Practical Scheme for the Safeguarding of Peace* (London 1934); Jonathan Griffin, *Britain's Air Policy: Present and Future* (London 1935). Norman Angell publicized Griffin's proposals by publishing them as an appendix in his own call for internationalization: Norman Angell, *The Menace to our National Defence* (London June 1934), 166–70.

39 See the correspondence between David Davies and Clifford Allen, B10/1, Davies Papers. Griffin, *Britain's Air Policy*, op. cit., 79.

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mostly British pacifist organizations sent a declaration to the Disarmament Conference in July 1932 calling for the abolition of tanks and military aviation, but not the formation of an international air force or the internationalization of civil aviation. A member of the 'No More War Movement' wrote to the *Manchester Guardian* arguing that 'at best an international police force would only serve to perpetuate the political and economic status quo in Europe and to facilitate the repression of colonial populations.' Other prominent liberal internationalists looked not to aviation for a solution to international anarchy and the problem of sovereignty, but instead to the British Empire and Commonwealth. Alfred Zimmern called for the creation of a world order based on an 'international mind', J.C. Smuts imagined a future 'holistic' world order based on the Commonwealth, and Lionel Curtis supported an 'organic' Commonwealth.[40]

H.G. Wells combined criticism of the League with his vision of internationalized aviation. Condemning the League of Nations as nothing more than 'the opiate of liberal thought in the world', he contended that such proposals were unworkable until an effective global international organization had been created. He criticized Davies's proposals for the creation of an international force as incomplete and insufficient; and described Henry de Jouvenel's proposals for international control (promoted in Britain by *Essential News*) as being 'so plainly utopian and impractical in the face of the sovereign state system as to seem insincere'. Yet Wells' own fiction bristled with aviation and aviators as central transformative figures in international relations. He in particular shared with other liberal internationalists an understanding of aviators as modern heroic apolitical experts, bound together in an international brotherhood through their profession, training and outlook.[41] Salvador de Madariaga, the self-styled 'world civil servant', believed that 'if we developed a team of 40 to 50,000 pilots and mechanics of all nations, all working for the same line, their brotherhood would have been

40 H.M. Swanwick, *Pooled Security: What Does it Mean?* (London 1934); H.M. Swanwick, *Pooled Frankenstein and His Monster: Aviation for World Service* (London 1934); H.M. Swanwick, *New Wars for Old* (London 1934); Gerald Bailey, Directing Secretary of the National Peace Council, Letter to the Editor, 'Military Aviation and Public Opinion', *Manchester Guardian*, 31 May 1933; Percy Bartlett, 'National Peace Council: A Constructive Peace Policy' (24 October 33), Box 89, Davies Papers. 'Socialists Warn M. Herriot. World Appeal to Conference', *Manchester Guardian*, 19 July 1932. E.A. Williams, Letter to the Editor, 'An International Police Force. Some of its Dangers', *Manchester Guardian*, 9 March 1934. Alfred Zimmern, *Quo Vadimus?* (London 1934); Paul Rich, 'Reinventing Peace', op. cit.; Peder Anker, *Imperial Ecology: Environmental Order in the British Empire, 1895–1945* (Cambridge, MA, 2001); Lionel Curtis, *Civitas Dei: The Commonwealth of God* (London 1938), 910–12; Deborah Lavin, *From Empire to International Commonwealth: A Biography of Lionel Curtis* (Oxford 1995).

41 H.G. Wells, *The New World Order: Whether it is Attainable, How it Can be Attained, and What Sort of World a World at Peace will have to be* (London 1940), 16, 104–6; H.G. Wells, *The Shape of Things to Come* (London 1993, first published 1933), 293. See also, by H.G. Wells, *The Outline of History: Being a Plain History of Life and Mankind, etc.* (London 1920); *Men Like Gods* (London 1923); *The Open Conspiracy* (London 1928); *The Shape of Things to Come*, op. cit.; *World Brain* (London 1938); and Wells, *The New World Order*, op. cit., 182–4.

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sufficient to ensure that not a single plane could be diverted to nefarious deeds'. Davies hoped that his international air police would double as a 'world technical college of the highest standing'. Recruits would 'undergo an intensive educational and scientific training' and emerge from service as 'graduates of a world university superbly equipped with technical knowledge . . . and fully trained to embark upon a civilian career in the allied professions and industries'. On returning home they would spread the 'international spirit', reducing 'national outlook' worldwide. Griffin's response to criticisms that his proposed internationalized commercial air fleet could still be misused for national military purposes was that:

> The international fraternity of the world's most skilled pilots and airway administrators will almost certainly be a strong factor making for peace generally, and in particular rendering the misuse of civil aviation almost impossible.[42]

An important aspect of liberal internationalists' understanding of aviation was that national military aviation was a perversion of the inherent civilian nature of aviation, a manifestation of the undue influence of the nation-state. For Madariaga, 'Military and naval reasons warp, distort and even subvert economic laws at every turn'. His 1929 book *Disarmament* noted:

> Commercial aviation is kept going by military protection. But this protection is the reverse of a blessing in disguise. It is a curse in disguise. It prevents a clear and unprejudiced case for aviation being made on its civil merits only. Further, it maintains a kind of tutelage on civil aircraft construction, thus hindering the free development of civil aircraft design by imposing on it military specifications.[43]

Internationalization would remove this distortion by allowing aviation to be protected from the militaristic and nationalist impulses of the nation-state, allowing it to reach its fullest potential. Military aviation under the control of international organization, in the form of an international air force, would be tolerable, as it would be shielded from interference from the nation-state.[44]

Proponents of international control were primarily concerned with international relations and security in Europe, and only secondarily with Europe's colonial possessions and the rest of the world. Consequently, although claiming that international control should and would eventually encompass the whole globe, they envisaged that it would initially cover only Western Europe and its imperial holdings, as well as the Commonwealth. The influence of French proposals also pushed internationalists in this direction. Davies's abridged edition of his earlier *Problem of the Twentieth Century* hoped that at the very least the 'four Great

42 Salvador de Madariaga, *Morning without Noon: Memoirs* (Westmead, Farnborough, 1973), 251, 274. For his interwar calls for internationalization, see Salvador de Madariaga, *Disarmament* (London 1929), 7–8; Salvador De Madariaga, *The World's Design* (London 1938), 64–9. Davies, *The Problem of the Twentieth Century*, op. cit., 448–9, 700; Griffin, *Britain's Air Policy*, op. cit., 48–9.

43 Madariaga, *Disarmament*, op. cit., 7–8.

44 Other prominent examples of the militaristic-perversion argument are: Noel-Baker, *Disarmament*, op. cit.; Noel-Baker, 'The International Air Police Force', op. cit.

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Powers of Western Europe' would pool their air forces. For Griffin Western Europe was to form a core, whilst 'the Dominions and the countries of the American Continent and East Asia join with Europe in the collective system as an outer ring of counties less rigidly bound, on the principle of "concentric circles of security"'. The United States, he (and others) hoped, would join once the scheme's commercial and security advantages became apparent.[45] Yet Empire played a significant role in debates about international control. Critics argued that international control would take away the very instrument used by imperial powers to effectively pacify and communicate throughout their empires. Proponents did not challenge aviation's usefulness in Empire – instead they emphasized that it would continue to be used for policing and communication. Davies's scheme allowed for the retention of small inferior air forces by imperial powers specifically for colonial policing – 'a 1918 type of aeroplane, which is obsolete in a modern war, but which is good enough for policing semi-civilized tribes', though his international air force, being headquartered in Palestine, would also cover Empire. Griffin pointed out that his 'World Airways' scheme would have sufficient British representation to ensure that imperial aviation was fully developed.[46] Indeed, aerial policing of Empire appeared to offer evidence of the possibilities of an international air force, though the pitfalls of comparing Western Europe with semi-civilized colonies meant that this was only tamely alluded to, if at all.[47] Proponents of international control, it should be noted, were not against bombing – indeed the threat of bombardment by the international authority was a central feature in most proposals.[48]

The issue of Germany was more problematic. Proponents envisaged that Germany would participate in any scheme for international control and that she could be enticed to join through the promise of all-round armaments reductions and economic prosperity. Attlee, in response to pacifist and leftist criticisms that proposals for international control of aviation served only to cement Anglo-French power in Europe, argued (in 1937) that even limited internationalization would be sufficient to allow the League's economic policies to function, bringing prosperity to its members and enticing the fascist powers to join. Labour 'would not be content with a League which merely stabilized the existing conditions in the world. Collective security is essential in order that the real work of dealing

45 Davies, *An International Police Force*, op. cit., v-vi; Griffin, *Britain's Air Policy*, op. cit., 165.

46 For a review of criticism, see Griffin, *Britain's Air Policy*, op. cit., 63; David Davies, 'An International Police Force?', *International Affairs* 11(1) (January 1932), 76–99; Davies, *The Problem of the Twentieth Century*, op. cit., 360–82.

47 As in, for example, The New Commonwealth Society, *The Functions of an International Air Police* (London 1936), 11.

48 Bombers were an integral component of Davies' international air force; on the other hand, Noel-Baker's and Griffin's forces were to be composed of fighters only, with civilian aircraft being drafted in for bombing purposes as a final resort: Davies, *The Problem of the Twentieth Century*, op. cit., 440; Noel-Baker, 'The International Air Police Force', op. cit., 206–39; Griffin, *Britain's Air Policy*, op. cit., 116. De Jouvenel, as High Commissioner in French-mandated Syria from 1925 to 1926, had continued his predecessor's policy of bombing Damascus: Michael Provence, *The Great Syrian Revolt and the Rise of Arab Nationalism* (Austin, TX, 2005).

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with the causes of war should be taken in hand'.[49] Griffin, noting in 1935 that 'the moral authority of the League will be transfigured if the League is no longer patently the instrument of keeping Germany and the other defeated Powers down', argued that international control in fact offered the most practical way of combining 'equality for Germany with security for France and other countries'. He pointed out that the USA, Canada, Argentina and Japan had already, during the 1933 disarmament conference, agreed to submit their national aviations to international control if Europe agreed to internationalization of aviation.[50] Yet proponents made a point of noting that internationalized aviation's security umbrella would protect not only the contracting parties from each other, but also from those, such as Germany, who might choose to remain outside. Attlee warned: 'If the Fascist States prefer to remain outside, they must of course do so, and the League must maintain forces strong enough to resist any attempt at aggression'. For the New Commonwealth, an attack by a 'non-member aggressor' on any one of the contracting nations was an attack on the whole agglomeration, and was to be met with force.[51]

Relations between European states significantly worsened through the 1930s. The disarmament conference adjourned (permanently, as it turned out) and without any substantial agreements in June 1934. Japan announced its withdrawal from the League in March 1933, Germany in October 1933 and Italy in December 1937. Italy invaded Abyssinia in October 1935, Japan invaded China in the summer of 1937, and the Spanish Civil War raged, with substantial foreign intervention, between 1936 and 1939. Yet calls for international control remained strong in Britain until the mid-1930s, and did not entirely disappear in the late 1930s. Amongst the Liberal and Labour Parties, for example, support only gradually dropped away after 1936. Growing anti-fascist feeling, combined with growing support for national rearmament, led to a move away from broad and inclusive conceptions of collective security and towards ones based on alliances. In the case of the Liberal Party, this move was gradual and was more or less complete by 1938, by which point the Party instead supported 'collective security through alliances'. In 1937 the Labour Party dropped international control from its detailed foreign policy statement, *International Policy and Defence*, and it was not mentioned at all during the 1937 Annual Conference.[52]

Belief in the need for international control of aviation was sustained by several factors. First, it was believed that international control was acceptable

49 C.R. Attlee, *The Labour Party in Perspective* (London 1937), 224–5. For criticism, see E.A. Williams, Letter to the Editor, 'An International Police Force. Some of its Dangers', *Manchester Guardian*, 9 March 1934.

50 Griffin, *Britain's Air Policy*, op. cit., 75, 76, 131.

51 Attlee, *The Labour Party in Perspective*, op. cit; The New Commonwealth Society, *The Functions of an International Air Police*, op. cit., 7.

52 Grayson, *The Liberals, International Relations and Appeasement*, op. cit., 93–4; National Council of Labour, International Policy and Defence (London 1937); Labour Party, *Report of the Annual Conference of the Labour Party* (London 1937).

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across the Allied European nations, including Italy. Many delegates paid lip service to it during the conference, and some put forward their own detailed proposals.[53] Internationalists believed that much of the blame for the failure of the conference was due to the British government, and consequently that the conference or disarmament negotiations could be reconvened with a sincere British initiative. Many insisted that Germany could even be coaxed into rejoining the League. In support, internationalists were able to point to various continuing arms limitation discussions, most importantly those for an 'Air Locarno' between Germany, France and Britain in early 1936. For some, such as Geoffrey Mander and David Davies, the putative Western Air Defence Pact provided a basis for an international air force, whereas Griffin attacked the Air Locarno discussions for not going far enough.[54]

Second, League-orientated collective security carried significant rhetorical appeal. The 1934–5 Peace Ballot appeared to signal widespread support for League collective security, leading the three main political parties to voice support for it in the run-up to the November 1935 General Election. Even the Left, critical of the League in the early 1930s, began to show some measure of support for it once the Soviet Union joined in September 1934, with the split in the Socialist League's ranks between those advocating collective action through the League and those still dismissing it becoming particularly pronounced by late 1935. Many supporters were undeterred by the failure of the League to act over the Italian invasion of Abyssinia (1935–6) and the December 1935 Hoare-Laval Pact. Noel-Baker, for example, stood on a strongly pro-League and pro-collective security platform at the July 1936 Derby by-election and overturned a government majority of 12,000. Abyssinia and the Hoare-Laval Pact appeared to demonstrate Britain's and France's unwillingness to take disarmament and League collective security seriously, rather than any intrinsic issues in the notion of League collective security itself. International control of aviation could still prevent war, if only it were given a chance.[55]

Many supporters, particularly from 1935 onwards, were able to successfully reconcile their support for national armaments with support for international control by arguing that British military aircraft could be transferred to an international air force once the fascist threat passed. Proposals for international control even managed to attract critics of

53 See J.M. Spaight, *Air Power in the Next War* (London 1938), 61–72; and on the conference generally, see Kitching, *Britain and the Geneva Disarmament Conference*, op. cit.

54 HC Deb, 18 December 1935, vol. 307, col. 1856; HL Deb, 1 May 1935, vol. 96, col. 735; Griffin, *Britain's Air Policy*, op. cit., 163–83. See also Noel-Baker, 'Disarmament', op. cit.

55 Ceadel, 'The First British Referendum', op. cit.; Corthorn, 'The Labour Party and the League of Nations', op. cit. For Stafford Cripps's continued criticism of League collective security, see Stafford Cripps, *The Struggle for Peace* (London 1936), 53–65. Though note that Cripps supported League collective security in parliament in 1933: HC Deb, 13 November 1933, vol. 281, cols 677–90. For a collective security-orientated response to the Abyssinian crisis, see Liberal MP Dingle Foot's intervention in the Commons: HC Deb, 1 August 1935, vol. 304, cols 2917–25. 'Derby Election Result', *The Times*, 10 July 1936.

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appeasement such as Winston Churchill, who assumed the Presidency of the British section of the New Commonwealth Society in 1936.[56] Events such as the bombing of Guernica only reinforced the bomber's status as the pre-eminent weapon of war, and worsened international relations in fact offered unusual opportunities for action. In 1938 David Davies gathered together a group of interested internationalists (including Pierre Cot, Philip Noel-Baker and Ludwik Rajchman) whilst attending a peace conference in Paris, and attempted to form a volunteer international air force to protect Chinese cities from Japanese aggression. In 1940 he even considered the formation of such a force to aid Finland during the Soviet-Finnish War, and accompanied Harold Macmillan on a visit there.[57]

By contrast, in France support dissipated much more rapidly from 1934 onwards. The increasing polarization of French political life led to the thinning of the liberal Centre/Centre-Left, which abandoned international control as it turned to the Right or, as in the case of the bulk of the Radical Party in 1935, the Left. In 1934 Louise Weiss left *L'Europe Nouvelle* to campaign for women's rights and Henry de Jouvenel passed away in 1935. *L'Europe Nouvelle*'s final call for internationalized aviation was in February 1934; the magazine subsequently became a supporter of national aerial rearmament. Cot (appointed Minister for Aviation in January 1933) continued to call for international control at the League and at internationalist meetings, though he ultimately forged ahead with French aerial rearmament.[58]

The outbreak of the second world war turned minds away from international control, but only briefly. By 1942 it was once again being seriously discussed. Proposals revived on the back of the expectation that postwar reconstruction would require international organization, that a powerful international political organization would be formed after the war, and that postwar Western Europe might need to be united politically and economically. Anglo-American co-operation and the formation of a United Nations alliance under an Atlantic Charter boosted internationalist hopes for a new postwar world order.

56 Pugh, 'Policing the World', op. cit. Churchill's involvement with the New Commonwealth Society has been portrayed by Pugh and others as entirely opportunistic, though Churchill's earlier comments on an international air force (Churchill, *The World in Crisis*, op. cit., 27), his enthusiasm for the use of aviation in Empire, and for scientific invention and mechanical means of warfare more generally (Geoffrey Best, *Churchill at War* (London 2005), 43–5, 69), imply a certain affinity with aerial policing.

57 Ian Patterson, *Guernica and Total War* (London 2007). Jenkins, 'Lord Davies, Howard Hughes and the "The Quinine Proposition"', op. cit.; and Bauernfeind, 'Lord Davies and the New Commonwealth Society', op. cit.

58 Roger Beaucaire, 'Aviation Commerciale et Èconomie Fermée', *L'Europe Nouvelle* 17 (10 February 1934), 141–3; 'L'Avenir de l'aviation française: Interview de M. Pierre Cot', *L'Europe Nouvelle* 18 (5 January 1935), 13–14; *L'Europe Nouvelle* Special Issue: *Le problème des armements devant l'effort militaire du Reich* 18 (18 May 1935), 479–85. On the Radical Party's turn to the Popular Front, see Julian Jackson, *The Popular Front in France: Defending Democracy, 1934–1938* (Cambridge 1990), 36–51.

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Internationalists were also able to argue that an international air force was already being formed in parts of the world. They could point to the formation of an American volunteer air force in China, commonly called an 'international air force' in Britain,[59] but most importantly to the RAF, which from 1942 onwards began to be seen as an already successful combination of international pilots, and so as a template for or even the nucleus of a postwar international air force.[60] Many, captivated by the aerial potential of the United States and talk of Anglo-American (and Western European) federation, explicitly stipulated an Anglo-American force. For David Davies, such a force would be able to 'impose disarmament upon every country' and to police a newly federated Europe. Stephen King-Hall, a widely read commentator on current affairs, argued that a 'joint British-American Fleet and Air Force', under some international organization, would maintain Britain's historical reliance on international policing through technically advanced arms.[61]

Yet technical developments in aviation had by now made clear the divergence in military and civil aviation. The interwar argument, so common amongst both supporters and detractors of international control, that civil aviation offered a pool of resources for military aviation and so had to be internationally controlled in tandem with military aviation, began to disappear. Proposals for the international control of military aviation and of civil aviation were consequently increasingly made without reference to each other. The League of Nations Union, David Davies and the Liberal Party continued to advocate complete international control as a singular package.[62] But these were no longer influential sources of thinking on such matters. The most significant wartime debates on and calls for international control took place within government, Chatham House and the Labour Party. In these arenas discussions on the internationalization of commercial aviation and the international control of military aviation were distinct and separated. The Labour Party reaffirmed its

59 Chinese requests for British participation in the force are mentioned in Stephen G. Craft, *V.K. Wellington Koo and the Emergence of Modern China* (Lexington, KY, 2004), 141.

60 For example: Polyglot, 'Letter to the Editor: International Policing', *Manchester Guardian*, 8 May 1942; 'Air Training', *The Economist* 5156 (20 June 1942), 861–2; Harold Laski, *Reflections on the Revolution of Our Time* (London 1943), 244; J.E. Wheeler, Untitled Book Review, *International Affairs Review Supplement* 19(12) (June 1943), 629.

61 David Davies, 'Aeroplanes may become the Sky Police of the World' (19 July 1940), File 'NC Memoranda, 1940', Box 92, Davies Papers. Letter, David Davies to Oscar Newfang (*c.* January 1941), Folder 12, Box 5, Series I, Wright Papers. Stephen King-Hall, *Total Victory* (London 1941), 214–22; Stephen King-Hall, *Britain's Third Chance: A Book about Post-War Problems and the Individual* (London 1943), 15.

62 'League of Nations Union. International Air Force', *Manchester Guardian*, 28 June 1941; League of Nations Union, *Annual Report for 1944* (London 1945). Cecil, long against comprehensive international control, turned for it during the war: Viscount Cecil, *A Real Peace* (London 1941); Cecil, 'Memorandum on Post-War Organisation Against Aggression', LNU paper S.707 (20 February 1940), File 'NC Memoranda, 1940', Box 92, Davies Papers. In September 1942 David Davies managed to convince the Liberal Party Annual Conference to support complete internationalization: 'Liberal Party Programme. Reconstruction and a Social Policy', *Manchester Guardian*, 5 September 1942; Archibald Sinclair, *The People's Party* (London 1942).

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commitment to an international air force in its 1939 Peace Aims, though dropped talk of internationalizing civil aviation. This commitment remained through the war. In December 1940 Home Secretary Herbert Morrison called for the abolition of European national air forces and their replacement by a pan-European air force, and the National Executive Committee reaffirmed the commitment in a report circulated to the 1942 Annual Conference. The Fabian International Bureau debated proposals for a postwar international air force, and the Party agreed at the 1944 Annual Conference that future international authority must have an internationalized force.[63]

Labour Party proposals for the internationalization of civil aviation meanwhile were made separately from its calls for an international air force, even though an important rationale for the former was still international security. In April 1944 the Party's Committee on Transport published *Wings for Peace: Labour's Post-War Policy for Civil Flying*. This demanded that a 'World Air Authority' must own and operate a 'World Airways' with a monopoly on international trunk routes. The Authority would own *all* civil aircraft, even those leased to national airlines servicing domestic routes. The Committee conceded that such internationalization would not occur immediately: the interim aim would be the internationalization on a regional basis throughout the world, including the formation of a pan-European 'Europa Airways' and a 'British Commonwealth Airways'. This would allow for the growth of aviation internationally at lower cost and with less wasteful competition, unifying the peoples of the world and bringing peace.[64]

The most vocal Labour supporters, although not without influence, were, however, on the fringe of the party. The ex-Liberal Labour MP Frank Bowles was particularly active within parliament, and headed a World Airways Joint Committee which propagandized for a 'world communications authority', which would start with aviation but eventually include 'all international communications – railways, shipping, telegraphs, posts etc'. This Committee was funded by David Caradog's World Unity Movement, a prominent wartime internationalist organization whose members included Vera Britain, G.E.G. Catlin, Leonard Hill, L. Hogben, Madariaga, John Boyd Orr and Olaf Stapledon. Michael Dunlop Young, Director of PEP (1941–5) and (from 1945) head of Labour research, wrote press articles and pamphlets calling for internationalization throughout the war. In 1947 his exposition of Labour's policies, *Labour's Plan for Plenty*, emphasized Labour's continued

63 Clement Atlee, *Labour's Peace Aims* (London 1939); Victor Altman, *The International Police Force and World Security* (London 1945), 9; National Executive Committee of the Labour Party, *The Old World and the New Society: A Report on the Problems of War and Peace Reconstruction* (London 1942); H.R.G. Greaves, Memorandum, 'The Minimal Requirements of an International System' (undated, c. July 1944), File: 'Section 1E2', Section E, Woolf Papers; W. Arnold-Forster, *The United Nations Charter Examined* (London 1946), 33.

64 The Labour Party, *Wings for Peace: Labour's Post-War Policy for Civil Flying* (London April 1944). The pamphlet was largely written by William Arnold-Forster. For earlier discussions, see Report, Civil Aviation Sub-committee of the Committee on Transport, Labour Party, December 1942, 3/15, PNB Papers.

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commitment to world government alongside internationalized civil aviation.[65]

Press opinion on the internationalization of civil aviation split in much the same way as it had done in the 1930s. The *Manchester Guardian* declared *Wings for Peace* a 'bold framework' for international aviation and supported regionalized internationalization, which it felt would be more acceptable to the Americans. Opponents, such as *The Times*, retorted that competition was required for development of aviation and that anyhow the Labour Party proposals were unrealistic, as they did not take American opposition into account. The Conservative Party organized opposition through the formation of a lobbying committee of four Conservative MPs (one a Vice-President of the British Airline Pilots Association). Their manifesto reasoned that internationalization was not required for 'air security', 'would not be acceptable either to the USA or to the USSR' and was not 'practical politics'. *The Economist*'s response fell in between that of the rejectionists and proponents. It portrayed 'complete international control' as 'the ideal solution' for international aviation and commended *Wings for Peace* for putting this forward. However, it criticized the pamphlet for not taking British, American or Soviet government objections into account. The second-best solution, 'freedom of the skies', would be supported in the USA but not in Britain. Britain's most realistic policy was consequently a compromise: 'Freedom of the International Air, with the Commonwealth treated as a unit, and with a mutual sharing of imperial cabotage rights with the French and Dutch Empires.'[66]

The growing prominence of proposals for internationalization prompted Chatham House to bring together aviation industrialists, policy-makers and other interested parties to debate their merits in a series of meetings between March and October 1943. The Chatham House transportation specialist's paper calling for the internationalization produced in December 1942 provided a starting point for debate. During discussions, aviation industry representatives such as Frederick Handley Page and R.H. Thornton (Chairman of the Aviation Committee of the General Council of British Shipping) argued against internationalization and instead emphasized the

65 Frank Bowles, 'M.P. Wants World Authority to Control Civil Aviation', *Evening Standard*, 16 March 1944; also: World Airways Joint Committee, *Civil Aviation and World Unity: A Manifesto* (London 1944); F.G. Bowles and Major W.F. Vernon, *World Airways: What We Want* (London 1946). Prominent interventions in parliament were: HC Deb, 1 June 1943, vol. 390, cols 56–63 (where he cited the Americans Ely Culbertson and E.P. Warner in support); HC Deb, 29 February 1944, vol. 397, cols 1321–83; HC Deb, 14 March 1944, vol. 398, cols 64–168; HC Deb, 20 October 1944, vol. 403, cols 2731–70. Michael Dunlop Young, *Civil Aviation* (London 1944); James Avery Joyce and Michael Young, *Chicago Commentary: The Truth about the International Air Conference* (London 1945); Michael Dunlop Young, *Labour's Plan for Plenty* (London 1947), 125–9, 131–5.

66 'World Aviation', *Manchester Guardian*, 18 October 1944; 'Air Transport', *Manchester Guardian*, 13 March 1943; 'A World Air Authority', *The Times*, 27 April 1944. Ronald Tree et al., *Air Transport Policy: By Four Conservative Members of Parliament* (London August 1943). 'Air Transport', *The Economist* 144 (6 March 1943), 286–8; 'Civil Aviation', *The Economist* 144 (5 June 1943), 713–4; 'Civil Aviation', *The Economist* 146 (1 April 1944), 424–6; 'Wings for Peace', *The Economist* 146 (29 April 1944), 583.

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need for 'freedom of the skies'. Proponents such as Noel-Baker and Arthur Longmore, a senior recently retired RAF officer, emphasized the reconstruction of international aviation as an inherent part of postwar European reconstruction.[67]

Astonishingly, the British state itself, for a brief time, contemplated postwar internationalization of civil aviation as official policy. A (largely Liberal) constituency within the civil service and government argued that it provided an expeditious way of protecting international British commercial aviation from the expected postwar international expansion of American airlines and of extending British aviation across Europe. The choice was, as one report put it, between 'Americanization' or 'internationalization'.[68] A series of interdepartmental and Ministerial committees (including the 'Finlay' and 'Shelmerdine' committees) from late 1941 to March 1943 considered various proposals. Although there was significant appetite for internationalization on a regional basis, expected American opposition eventually led to adoption of a scheme of heavy international regulation as the official stance for the upcoming November 1944 international Chicago conference on aviation.[69] An international air force, meanwhile, garnered little support within government – apart from Churchill, the only other vocal proponent was Arthur Longmore, who pushed, in vain, for such a force within the Foreign Office's Post-Hostilities Planning Committee in early 1944.[70]

During the interwar period there had been little appetite amongst both American internationalists and the American government for a powerful international political or security organization, and consequently little appetite for an international police force. The American Peace Society's widely read journal *Advocate of Peace*, for example, consistently voiced its opposition in the late 1920s and early 1930s.[71] Yet as the postwar formation of some such

67 H.O. Mance, 'Air Transport and the Future: Some International Problems', *The Bulletin of International News* XIX (26 December 1942), 1173–8. 'Private Discussion Meeting. The Future of Aviation' (21 October 1943), 8/992, Chat Papers; 'Informal discussion meeting. The Future of Aviation' (24 March 1943), 8/986, Chat Papers.

68 Lord Finlay, *Internationalisation of Civil Aviation After the War*, War Cabinet Report RP(42) 48 (18 December 1942), AIR 2/5491, PRO.

69 Christopher Brewin, 'British Plans for International Operating Agencies for Civil Aviation, 1941–1945', *International History Review* 4(1) (1982), 91–110; and David R. Devereux, 'British Planning for Postwar Civil Aviation 1942–1945: A Study in Anglo-American Rivalry', *Twentieth Century British History* 2(1) (1991), 26–46.

70 Julian Lewis, *Changing Direction: British Military Planning for Post-war Strategic Defence, 1942–1947* (London 1988), 65–9; Arthur Longmore, *From Sea to Sky: 1910–1945* (London 1946), 301–2. The Committee eventually commissioned Spaight to produce a report outlining why 'an international police force is not in fact a practical possibility at the present stage': A.T. Cornwall Jones, Secretary, PHP subcommittee, 'An International Police Force. Note by the Secretary' (11 May 1944), FO 371/40795, PRO.

71 'Editorials: Coming Around', *Advocate of Peace* 89 (November 1927), 587–8; 'Editorials', *Advocate of Peace* 91 (Feb 1929), 88; Editorial, 'An International Force', *Advocate of Peace* 93 (December 1931), 201–2.

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organization gathered acceptability in America during the war and the possibilities of stationing American forces in foreign bases became apparent, so the notion of an international air force caught on. Proposals and concepts circulated more widely than just amongst organized internationalists. They spread in university circles through political science textbooks and academic papers; and in State Department circles through Council on Foreign Relations reports and through the State Department's own working groups on postwar international organization.[72] An international air force was raised at the earliest State Department postwar planning sessions in January 1940; within various committees reporting to Leo Pasvolsky's Advisory Committee on Post-War Foreign Policy through to July 1943; and within the Informal Agenda Group in July and August 1943.[73] Internationalist organizations such as the Commission to Study the Organization of Peace and the Council on Foreign Relations (through its War and Peace Studies) discussed an international air force in some detail. Reports of the Commission to Study the Organization of Peace were circulated nationally to internationalist organizations through the Carnegie Endowment and the League of Nations Association (later the American Association for the United Nations).[74] Proponents such as E.P. Warner, James T. Shotwell, Hamilton Fish Armstrong and Quincy Wright moved between academia, government, and internationalist organizations. Within the wider public the

72 Some examples: Quincy Wright, 'Peace Problems of Today and Yesterday', *American Political Science Review* 38(3) (June 1944), 512–21; Quincy Wright, 'National Security and International Police', *The American Journal of International Law* 37(3) (July 1943), 499–505; Quincy Wright, 'Fundamental Problems of International Organization', *International Conciliation* 369 (April 1941), 468–92; Walter R. Sharp, 'II. American Foreign Relations Within an Organized World Framework', *The American Political Science Review* 38(5) (October 1944), 931–44; Grayson Kirk and Walter R. Sharp, *Contemporary International Politics* (New York 1940), 169; Clyde Eagleton, *The Forces that Shape Our Future* (New York 1945), 108–17; James T. Shotwell, *The Great Decision* (New York 1944), 129; T.P. Wright, 'An Address Delivered at the Honors Night Dinner of the Institute of the Aeronautical Sciences – January 26, 1943', in idem, *Articles and Addresses of Theodore P. Wright* vol. III, *Impact of Aviation, University Activities* (Buffalo 1961), 9–15; Clark Eichelberger, 'Next Steps in the Organization of the United Nations', *Annals of the American Academy of Political and Social Science* 228 (July 1943), 34–9. The War and Peace Studies group of the Council on Foreign Relations generated a significant number of reports on international policing between October 1941 and December 1944. One example is T.P. Wright, *The Organization of an Airforce for International Policing* (29 March 1943), W-137-A-B84, Fiche 384, CFR Papers.

73 See: 'Memorandum [by Hugh R. Wilson] Arising from Conversations in Mr. Welles' Office, April 19 and 26', in Harley Notter (ed.), *Postwar Foreign Policy Preparation 1939–1945* (Washington, DC, 1949), 458–60; 'Minutes of the First Meeting of the Working Subcommittee on Security Problems' (15 April 1942), File 2.2, Box 1, Disarmament Files 1942–1952, Lot 58D 133, RG59, NARA; 'Minutes of the 47th Meeting of the Working Subcommittee on Security Problems' (16 July 1943), File 2.2, Box 1, Disarmament Files 1942–1952, Lot 58D 133, RG59, NARA.

74 See, in particular, 'Fourth Report of the Commission to Study the Organization of Peace', *International Conciliation* 396 (January 1944), 3–110, particularly 51–67; and 'General International Organization: Its Framework and Function by the Commission' in Commission to Study the Organization of Peace, *Building Peace: Reports of the Commission to Study the Organization of Peace, 1939–1972*, vol. 2 (Metuchen, NJ, 1973), 814–18.

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published works of best-selling authors such as Ely Culbertson and the pronouncements of Vice President Wallace were particularly well-known.[75] By 1944 these proposals were so numerous that the publisher H.W. Wilson published a short summary of debates and publications on the international police force as part of its Reference Shelf series on major contemporary issues. One surveyor noted that the concept had 'captured the public mind'. *Time Magazine* in September 1943 conducted a stock-take and noted that 74 per cent in a recent Gallup poll had voted for an international police force.[76]

Although *Time Magazine* and the Reference Shelf volume talked of an 'international police', increasingly between 1942 and 1944 it was either implicitly assumed or explicitly argued that such a force needed to be aerial in nature. This is evident in polls published by the internationalist Universities Committee on Post-War International Problems in June 1944. The 37 internationalist university groups polled, in the words of the Committee's report, 'strongly favor an international air police force'. Only two groups out of 37 thought that an international air police was impractical. The vast majority of respondents favoured a primarily or solely aerial force – some noted that it would be the 'least difficult form of international policing'. The notion that allied forces were already functioning together as one air force seemed widespread. The committee noted that 'several remark that we now have in the cooperative action of the various United Nations air forces the nucleus of a world air force. As one group put it, the RAF, the USAAF, the RCAF, and other allied air forces are now pretty well scrambled together; after the peace we should take care to "unscramble" them.'[77]

Many of the strongest proponents had close connections with European internationalists or had intimate knowledge or experience of European discussions on international control. Within the Commission to Study the Organization of Peace these were political scientists Quincy Wright and Clyde Eagleton, and academic and onetime diplomat James T. Shotwell; within the Council on Foreign Relations, *Foreign Affairs* editor Hamilton Fish Armstrong and senior aviation insiders T.P. Wright (in charge of wartime US aircraft production) and Edward P. Warner (vice chairman of the Civil Aeronautics Board); and within the State Department Under Secretary of State Sumner Welles. James T. Shotwell had been active in European diplomacy in the 1920s and had provided the foreword to a rare 1930s American call for international control; Edward P. Warner had brought Geneva international

75 Wallace's most prominent call was a highly publicized November 1942 speech: 'Text of Wallace's Pledge of Our Friendship to Russia in and After the War', *New York Times*, 9 November 1942. Ely Culbertson's best-selling call for an international police force armed with the latest scientific weapons was Ely Culbertson, *Total Peace: What makes Wars and How to Organize Peace* (London 1944). His rationale closely mirrored David Davies's.

76 Julia E. Johnsen (ed.), *International Police Force* (New York 1944). Jerome S. Bruner, 'Public Opinion and America's Foreign Policy', *American Sociological Review* 9(1) (February 1944), 50–6. 'International Police', *Time Magazine*, 13 September 1943.

77 Universities Committee on Post-War International Problems, 'Summaries of Reports of Cooperating Groups', *International Conciliation* 410 (April 1945), 249–60.

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control discussions to the attention of *Foreign Affairs* readers in 1932; Hamilton Fish Armstrong had attended the Geneva disarmament conference and had been a delegate to the 1935 International Studies Conference, where the New Commonwealth organized a barrage of lectures on an international air force and the internationalization of aviation. Sumner Welles had discussed the feasibility of a pan-European international air force with French and British leaders during his European tour in March 1940; and Quincy Wright was instrumental in forming the American branch of Madariaga's World Foundation.[78] More generally, interwar and wartime British proposals for an international police (particularly Davies's) were well known in wartime America – many were included in the H.W. Wilson bibliography and were cited in American proposals.[79]

Like their French and British counterparts, these internationalists also believed that modern aviation was transforming war and global societies. In their minds aviation was the most powerful example of a much broader transformation arising through the development of modern scientific inventions. Many such inventions (for the Commission to Study the Organization of Peace, the 'airplane, submarine, tank, motor transport, electrical communication and poison gas') were already transforming warfare into 'total' or 'totalitarian war'. An international force, they believed, would harness this impulse for the postwar reconstruction of international relations. James T. Shotwell, in his 1944 internationalist tract *The Great Decision*, announced that:

> modern science, by the invention of the airplane, has at last provided the nations of the civilized world with the means for having just such a limited but efficient police force. Before its advent as a military weapon, it was impossible for a policing expedition to reach many a scene of possible disorders without providing for the transit of armies across the territories of unwilling states... The airplane has changed all this, for there is now no spot anywhere on earth that cannot be reached within sixty hours from some central airport... Here then is the instrument ready at hand for the enforcement of peace in true police technique.[80]

78 Elvira K. Fradkin, *The Air Menace and the Answer* (New York 1934). Edward P. Warner, 'Can Aircraft be Limited?', *Foreign Affairs* 10(3) (April 1932), 431–43. Hamilton Fish Armstrong, *Peace and Counterpeace: From Wilson to Hitler* (New York 1971), 487–95. Maurice Bourquin (ed.), *Collective Security: A Record of the Seventh and Eighth International Studies Conferences, Paris 1934–London 1935* (Paris 1936). *Foreign Relations of the United States*, General Vol. I (1940), 65, 71, 78, 89. The American branch of de Madariaga's World Foundation would eventually become the Chicago-based World Citizens Association: Memo, Quincy Wright, 'Meeting with Salvador Madariaga' (20 Feb 1936), Folder A1, Box 4, WCA Papers; and Letter, Edwin M. Clough to Edgar Ansel Mowrer (5 Feb 1940), Folder A1, Box 4, WCA Papers.

79 Johnsen (ed.), *International Police Force*, op. cit. See for example: Wright, 'National Security and International Police', op. cit.

80 Shotwell, *The Great Decision*, op. cit., 129. See also Commission to Study the Organization of Peace, *Preliminary Report* (New York November 1940); Edward P. Warner, 'Douhet, Mitchell, Seversky: Theories of Air Warfare', in Edward M. Earle (ed.), *Makers of Modern Strategy: Military Thought from Machiavelli to Hitler* (Princeton 1944), 485–503; Quincy Wright, 'Inventions and War', *The Scientific Monthly* 53 (December 1941), 526–41; Wright, 'Peace Problems', op. cit.

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American thinking on an international air force was also closely intertwined with thinking and planning for the postwar formation of a United Nations Organization, as well as the acquisition of foreign bases for long-term American use. As the need for a future international political organization, to be composed primarily of the victorious Allied nations, began to gain widespread acceptance in 1942, so many internationalists came to see an American-dominated international air force as an integral part of such an organization. These proposals did not threaten the American air force: it was imagined that national air forces would be initially kept intact and only whittled down over many years. The acquisition of foreign bases for military use had already been greatly increased by mid-1941, and by 1943 internationalists were viewing these bases as an essential component of postwar international peace and order. The respondents to the Universities Committee on Post-War International Problems poll believed, for example, that the 'strategic air bases acquired during the course of the war should be placed under international control rather than be assigned to any one nation.' Even the Navy, Air Force and the Joint Chiefs of Staff felt obliged to couch proposals for the further acquisition of overseas bases for American military use in terms of the requirements for a future UN international air force.[81]

Roosevelt eventually decided against an international air force as policy, though the Soviets insisted on one during the 1944 Dumbarton Oaks conference, leading to the provision for one within Article 45 of the UN Charter. The envisaged force was to be massive. In later postwar negotiations, the US delegation would suggest a force consisting of 1250 bombers, 2250 fighters and fighter-bombers and 300 reconnaissance planes. The Soviets and Americans were unable to agree on its composition, though, and no such force was ever formed.[82]

There were very few calls for internationalization of civil aviation – Vice-President Henry Wallace's call for a UNO 'network of globe-girdling airways' was one. American internationalists were instead committed, to varying extents, to laissez-faire. They supported 'freedom of the skies'. There was an often unspoken realization that America's commercial and aerial expansion overseas would be best served by an international system based on bilateral treaty – which indeed is what emerged following the 1944 Chicago conference on international aviation. There was widespread disappointment amongst British liberals as to this result; less so in the United States. Quincy Wright

81 Universities Committee on Post-War International Problems, 'Summaries of Reports of Cooperating Groups', op. cit. Elliott V. Converse, *Circling the Earth: United States Plans for a Postwar Overseas Military Base System, 1942–1948* (Maxwell Air Force Base, AL, 2005).

82 The genealogy of the Soviet proposal is unclear. On this and the 1944 negotiations, see Robert C. Hilderbrand, *Dumbarton Oaks: The Origins of the United Nations and the Search for Postwar Security* (Chapel Hill, NC, 1990), 138–58. On postwar negotiations, see Jonathan Soffer, 'All for One or All for All: The UN Military Staff Committee and the Contradictions within American Internationalism', *Diplomatic History* 21(1) (Winter 1997), 45–69.

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and Sumner Welles were among the few American internationalists to vocally criticize the outcome at Chicago.[83]

Proposals for the formation of an international air force and the internationalization of civil aviation survived past 1945 but diminished rapidly, virtually disappearing by the end of the 1940s.[84] This is even though far-flung international airbases continued to be used for international 'policing' and 'peace-keeping' through 'U.N.' and 'coalition' forces for decades to come. Liberal internationalists had initially turned to aviation as it came to be seen as the great world-changing technology, but abandoned it with the introduction of the atomic bomb in August 1945. For a few years atomic energy instead assumed the mantle of the great international relations-transforming technology of the era (the new supposed 'atomic age') – though this rhetoric, too, dissipated eventually.

Proposals for international control clearly reflected national interest. Their effect on aviation would have been the freezing and then the institutionalization of the current aerial status quo into perpetuity. In the 1920s and early 1930s, as the leading aerial powers of Europe, France and Britain would have dominated any proposed scheme. Not only would they have influenced the military apparatus through their supply of airfields, equipment and personnel, but they also would have been ascendant in the controlling political organization. International control would undoubtedly have found little purchase in Britain, France and the USA if it had been imagined that internationalized aviation would have been used against these countries themselves. Yet, nevertheless, the proposals were internationalist in nature. They sought solutions to issues of national and international security, and international relations, through international organization. They flourished in years when it was assumed that co-operation with potential enemies such as Germany might be possible and only faded when hopes for such co-operation disappeared. Moreover, they were sustained not only by internationalist intercourse and international mindsets, but by an urge to seek technological solutions to the problems of international relations which themselves appeared to be rooted in modern science and technology.

83 Henry Wallace, 'What We Will Get out of the War', *American Magazine* (February 1943). On 'freedom of the skies', see Edward Warner, 'Chicago Air Conference: Accomplishments and Unfinished Business', *Foreign Affairs* 23(3) (April 1945), 406–21; more broadly, see Jenifer L. Van Vleck, 'The "Logic of the Air": Aviation and the Globalism of the "American Century"', *New Global Studies* 1 (2007), article 2. On Chicago, see David Mackenzie, 'An "Ambitious Dream": The Chicago Conference and the Quest for Multilateralism in International Air Transport', *Diplomacy and Statecraft* 2(2) (July 1991), 270–93. For reaction to Chicago, see 'The Air After Chicago', *The Economist* 147 (30 December 1944), 860–2; 'Setback at Chicago – Air Conference not wholly fruitless', *Manchester Guardian*, 8 December 1944; S. de Madariaga, 'Civil Aviation', *The Times*, 7 November 1944. Quincy Wright, 'The International Regulation of the Air', *The American Economic Review* 35(2) (May 1945), 243–8; and Sumner Welles, *Where are we Heading?* (London 1946, 1947), 28.

84 They were missing, for example, from the rhetoric of the newly emergent world federal movements; see Joseph Preston Baratta, *The Politics of World Federation*, vol. 2, *From World Federalism to Global Governance* (Westport, CT, 2004).

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